STATUS REPORT

Tanzania — digital transformation and data governance status report

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The Digital Economy Strategic Framework 2024–2034 now carries almost the whole of Tanzania's stated commitment on its own, spanning artificial intelligence, broadband, cybersecurity, data centres and cloud, data protection, digital identification, payments, signatures, e-commerce, e-waste, universal access and spectrum — the work several dedicated instruments would do elsewhere. It targets 80% broadband penetration and mobile-money use above 70% by 2029, ICT at 3% of GDP by 2029 against around 1.5% in 2022/23, an innovation hub in every region and 1,000 startups, and a digital economy contributing more than $1.1bn to GDP by 2034. It is also the standing vehicle under which connectivity, cloud, data-centre and payments investment is organised.

Delivery is split rather than held in one place: the ICT ministry coordinates the Jamii Namba, Jamii X-Change and Jamii Portal builds, while the e-Government Authority holds the coordinating role for government systems. The ICT Commission's own periodisation runs 2003 for institutions and backbone, 2016 for systems and platforms, and a current phase framed around trust — cybersecurity, data protection and skills — which it argues is what converts the platform layer into benefit.

The gap in that coverage is artificial intelligence, where the framework names the domain but no instrument governs it: guidelines were still being drafted on 30 July 2026 while AI use in public service delivery expanded. At a July 2026 event a deputy permanent secretary named "digital colonialism" as the risk attaching to healthcare AI, and a call for a dedicated healthcare-AI regulator came from the floor.

On the broader measure Tanzania scores 58.2 out of 100 for overall governance and 15th of 54 African states (2023), up 3.0 points over 2014–2023 against an African average gain of 1.0, and sits above the African average on 70 of the index's 96 indicators, improving on 58 and declining on 36. Independent assurance over the flagship programme exists and is public: the Controller and Auditor General ran a value-for-money audit of NIDA's registration and card issuance, reporting through the President to Parliament (March 2021).

Legislation and regulation

Tanzania made electronic payment compulsory across most of its consumer economy on 1 July 2026, by ministerial order rather than by regulations — Government Notice No. 158C, signed at Dodoma by the Minister for Finance under section 13(2) of the Electronic Transactions Act, Cap. 442. Its Schedule lists nine classes of transaction: transport fares, tolls and parking; malls, gyms, cinemas, filling stations and event venues; school fees from pre-primary to university; hotels and restaurants; tourism; sales of buildings, plots, farms and motor vehicles; and cooperative and AMCOS payments for the strategic crops. The duty binds the payee as well as the payer, and electronic means is defined technology-neutrally, from mobile money and cards to the government payment system. The power to make that order was created the same day: the Finance Act, 2026 amended section 13 of the Electronic Transactions Act to let the Minister for Finance prescribe by Gazette order which payments must be made electronically, and separately made proof of electronic payment a condition of approving any transfer of land, a building or a motor vehicle — an obligation on the registry rather than on the parties, and one the order's Schedule does not carry.

Two limits sit inside the Order. A business that was taking cash when it commenced has six months, to 1 January 2027, to put electronic means in place, and it does not affect arrangements or contracts made before it came into force. It is silent on who bears the transaction charge, and cash remains legal tender: the mandate falls on the transaction, not on the currency.

Around it stands a stack assembled over a decade — the Personal Data Protection Act 2022, in force since 1 May 2023; the Cybercrimes Act 2015; the Electronic and Postal Communications Act, revised in 2022; and the e-Government Act 2019, which obliges public institutions to share data electronically. The newest addition is the Electronic Transactions (Certification Services) Regulations 2025, GN No. 134, the rules beneath digital signatures and authentication.

The holes are in identity and in the sector's own governing statute. The Infant Registration Bill, which would register children from birth and carry the same number onto the national ID at 18, was still unpassed in January 2026, the registration pilot running ahead of its enabling law; the ICT Bill 2026 has been urged on Parliament by the committee scrutinising the communications budget without being enacted (April 2026). The High Court confirmed in May 2024 that general judicial review of administrative and ministerial decisions survives, which matters where the identity statute ends its appeal route at the Minister.

Data protection

The state is now requiring the publication of the identifiers it elsewhere protects: Government Notice No. 158G, made by the Minister for Finance on 30 June 2026 and in operation from 1 July, adds a sub-regulation requiring a person conducting business on social media to display the certificate, taxpayer identification number or tax clearance certificate on the profile or account, and digital creators and online traders have objected that publishing them exposes them to impersonation and fraud (August 2026). The notice carries no penalty provision, no data-protection assessment or redress route is published for the rule, and the objections are those of named traders reported by the paper rather than a regulator finding. More than a year after the deadline to register with the regulator expired, institutions in health and education were still processing personal data unregistered, and in June 2026 the Personal Data Protection Commission was telling citizens to check that a body is registered before handing over their data. Registration is mandatory under section 15 and the final deadline expired on 30 April 2025; in February 2026 the responsible Minister issued a final three-month ultimatum backed by the threat of legal action, and in June the Commission's Director General gave institutions part-way through seven days to finish.

The law itself is broad. The Personal Data Protection Act No. 11 of 2022 has bound public and private bodies alike since 1 May 2023, biometric data included; regulations GN No. 449C of 2023 established the Commission as supervisory authority, section 27(3) makes a data protection officer mandatory, and section 3 reaches controllers and processors outside the country. It applies in full on the Mainland but extends to Zanzibar only in respect of Union Matters. Outward transfers are decided case by case against the destination's own protection or an evidenced safeguard, with no adequacy route and a ministerial power to bar destinations outright, and the requirement runs across categories of personal data rather than one sector.

Breach reporting is asymmetric. Section 27(5) requires a controller to notify the Commission of any security breach without undue delay, with no risk or harm threshold, yet neither "security breach" nor "without undue delay" is defined in the Act or its regulations, and nothing obliges a controller to tell the people whose data was taken. The penalty runs from TZS 100,000 to TZS 5,000,000 — roughly USD 41 to USD 2,030 in February 2026 — imprisonment of up to five years, or both.

The regime has begun to produce outcomes for individuals: the Commission made its first monetary award for a privacy violation in 2025. Against that, Digital Freedom is Tanzania's third most deteriorated governance indicator, down 22.5 points over 2014–2023 to 46.3 out of 100 and 29th of 54, with Personal Liberties down 15.1 points to 53.8.

Regional collaboration

The rules that would let Tanzanian data move around East Africa were approved at official level on 24 July 2026 and go no further until the Community's decision-making organs take them; nothing binds Tanzania yet and no adoption date is published. The regional body that speaks for East African business puts the constraint on a single digital market in the same place — divergent tax and data-protection frameworks, uneven cybersecurity readiness and skills rather than physical build.

Money crosses the border the old way. Payments out of Tanzania run through the regional East African Payment System and SADC-RTGS rather than through the instant-payment system, and the Tanzania–Rwanda instant-payment corridor was still being worked through at a technical meeting in Zanzibar in July 2026 rather than running. The single East African currency target stayed at 2031 at the Monetary Affairs Committee's July 2026 meeting, which minuted that no partner state, Tanzania included, has attained all four primary macroeconomic convergence criteria; the agreed remedy is a peer review mechanism for macroeconomic surveillance and operational frameworks for the 2026/27–2030/31 development strategy.

The one component held up as a model for others is the least glamorous. The Pan African Postal Union's Secretary General named Tanzania's addressing work and its UPU S42 certification a benchmark for the continent in February 2026, arguing that without harmonised addressing e-commerce cannot scale and the AfCFTA cannot reach its potential.

Beyond the bloc, officials position the country's data-governance work inside the African Union Data Policy Framework of 2022, developed with AU and UNECA cooperation (August 2025), and Tanzania used the Geneva Global Dialogue on AI Governance in July 2026 to argue for global AI frameworks that do not leave developing countries behind. Membership of both the EAC and SADC underpins a regional integration score of 57.2 out of 100 and 15th of 54 in 2023, up 1.5 points over the decade.

Standards

The instruments exist and the assessment did not find them. A 2016 interoperability framework defines nine technical-standards areas — interconnection, access, collaboration, data integration and the rest — that public institutions must follow, and is still the referenced framework in the authority's 2026 capability maturity model; two board-approved standards were issued under the e-government statute in February 2026, one setting secure development-lifecycle controls, audit logs, privacy by design and open interoperable design with government-controlled source-code hosting for government applications, the other setting site, power, cooling and utility requirements for approved hosting environments; and a national data governance strategy reached a validation workshop in March 2026 without being adopted. Against that, the 2025 GovTech assessment records no government data governance framework in place — a striking absence in a country the same exercise places in the top maturity band alongside Kenya, Rwanda, Uganda and Egypt. The same assessment records government ICT standards as partially rather than uniformly adopted, with a ministry-level chief information officer function and a government CIO role in place, and government software policy as mandatory rather than advisory.

Where a published standard has been adopted wholesale it has paid: the national addressing system is certified to the Universal Postal Union's S42 international standard, and the certification services underpinning digital signatures and electronic authentication were given rules in 2025. Interconnection itself is real rather than aspirational: GovESB is the secure system-to-system spine between ministries, and it is the basis on which the country is now scored.

The weakness is in publication and in enforcement. The rules governing the instant payment scheme are released to participants and non-participants only on request, unlike the payments statute and the cheque-clearing and RTGS rules the central bank puts online — and the same central bank built the system in house and operates it as well as regulating it, so scheme rules, oversight and operations sit in one institution. On the street the absence of an enforced sharing standard is visible: rapid fibre rollout in Dar es Salaam has left roads carrying five or more poles belonging to different operators, with large towers and environmental assessment falling to the environment regulator and fibre poles to the communications sector (February 2026).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Freedom of association and assembly is Tanzania's lowest score on any of the 96 indicators the Ibrahim Index measures — 12.5 out of 100 in 2023, down 25.0 points over the decade — with civil society space down 22.2 points to 38.0 and 34th of 54. The picture inside that is not uniform: media freedom rose 7.7 points to 55.8 and 24th of 54 over the same decade while freedom of expression and belief fell 11.6 points to 60.2, and Tanzanians' own confidence in free speech remains near the top of the continent at 88.1 and 2nd of 54, though it has itself fallen 11.9 points since 2014. Around the October 2025 election censorship, VPN registration requirements and shutdowns carried a substantial economic cost.

The formal machinery exists. An online platform for public participation in consultation on policy and legislation is in place, as is a citizen feedback and grievance mechanism (2025), and an access-to-information law is on the books. What is harder is getting the material to argue with: the accessibility and disclosure of public records are among Tanzania's weakest governance scores, inside an accountability and transparency sub-category that fell over the decade, and digital citizen engagement is the weak pillar of the region's GovTech performance, Tanzania's top-tier placement notwithstanding.

Where argument does break through is on money. One month into the cash-lite mandate users were pressing the central bank to impose a directed price on transfer and payment charges, on the argument that absent a cap each provider sets its own rate and the customer carries it; the Governor rejected a cap, saying charges are already low and predicting competition will cut them within six months. Commentary on the mandate itself has divided, weighing transparency and efficiency against unresolved gaps in infrastructure, cybersecurity, affordability and inclusion. On privacy the state convenes in numbers: the first National Privacy and Personal Data Protection Conference drew more than 800 delegates to Dar es Salaam in June 2026.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

Zanzibar's ICT infrastructure agency ZICTIA and Yas Fibre signed a 20-year broadband partnership worth about TZS 300 billion (US$114.5 million) in June 2026, under which roughly 100,000 households across Unguja and Pemba are to be connected. It is the exception in a record otherwise made of memoranda that carry no money. The same agency signed one with Airtel Tanzania in August 2025 on broadband and digital inclusion, with no value disclosed, and Zanzibar's communications ministry holds a capacity-building memorandum with the firm Serensic Africa covering user awareness of phishing and weak passwords alongside specialist training (June 2026).

At union level the communications ministry holds a memorandum with Viettel Global on network upgrades and rural masts (April 2026), with no value or delivery date attached, and Axian Telecom has pledged to expand 4G across Madagascar, Comoros and Tanzania under the ITU's voluntary Partner2Connect framework — a pledge rather than a signed financing. Outside government, the Tanzania Privacy Professionals Association announced a memorandum with India's Sandbox Security and with TAFINA in August 2026 on combining legal safeguards with technical ones, disclosing no terms, funding or timeline, and M-Pesa Tanzania and PayPal have agreed wallet interoperability through the M-Pesa Super App (May 2026).

New investments

Thirty-six digital-sector commitments to Tanzania are on the record as at August 2026, starting between 2015 and 2026 and with windows running out as far as 2034; the 32 recorded directly against Tanzania come to about US$818 million, from US$1 million grants to a single US$150 million World Bank operation, which is the largest live commitment. Connectivity has taken the largest share, about US$416 million across seven commitments, ahead of payments and fintech — the most numerous subsector, nine commitments but US$118 million — then digital identity and civil registration at US$94 million across two, land and geospatial data at US$65 million in one loan, and data centres at US$50 million. Nineteen of the 36 are grants, against five equity investments and three concessional loans, and the count inverts the value: those three loans alone are US$285 million. The largest financiers by money are the Axian/Yas group at about US$214 million, the World Bank, Korea's Economic Development Cooperation Fund at US$135 million and Wingu Africa at US$50 million; the most frequent are the Gates Foundation, five grants worth about US$17 million, and the European Union, four worth €26.9 million (US$32 million). Commitments beginning in 2025 or 2026 are mostly private commercial capital rather than aid.

The World Bank's US$150 million Digital Tanzania Project runs from 2021 to 2026, and Korea's development fund signed two concessional loans in October 2022, US$70 million to expand the resident registration system and US$65 million to digitise land information. Phase II of the digital ID build, on a Korea Eximbank loan inside the World Bank project, pays for a NIDA headquarters in Dodoma and registration offices in 31 districts. Huawei is financing a buyer's credit to the state operator to extend the national broadband backbone into 23 further districts. In the private market, Axian and Rostam Azizi bought Millicom's Tanzanian operations for US$100 million in April 2022, rebranding them Yas Tanzania, and Vodacom completed a US$28 million rebuild of M-Pesa's platform in April 2026. MIGA's US$40 million cover for The Rise Fund II's stake in Airtel Money Tanzania, its first Tanzanian contract since 2014, is risk cover, not capital.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

5G reached 32.83% of Tanzania's population in the quarter to March 2026, up from 30.13%, but only about 11% of its territory, and the count of 5G facilities rose 139% to 1,804 in that quarter, taking Katavi, Lindi, Mtwara and North Pemba into coverage for the first time.

Reach runs well ahead of use. 4G already covered most of the population by June 2024, yet 29.1% of Tanzanians used the internet in 2023. The handset binds tighter than the network: smartphone penetration rose from 31.55% in June 2024 to 35.99% by December 2024, leaving roughly two thirds of mobile users without one, and it has kept climbing since without closing that gap. Price sits closer to solved: a data-only mobile broadband basket cost roughly 2% of gross national income per capita in 2023, at the boundary between the affordable and moderately expensive bands.

The spine has moved fast. The national backbone reached 15,167 km and 122 of 139 districts, 87.8%, by March 2026, 13 added that year, and its capacity rose tenfold, from 200 Gbps to 2,000 Gbps, by December 2025, a period in which submarine cable landings went from two to three and the backbone was linked to Mombasa by the Horohoro–Tanga route. The Tanzania Internet Exchange in Dar es Salaam now holds 32 or more peering networks including Meta and Akamai (2026).

Much of that build is not the state's own. A telco consortium handed 758 towers and about 1,100 km of fibre to the government in April 2026, though it had paid US$11.4m of a US$20m obligation by that month. The ministry has asked Parliament for about Sh222.5bn for 2026/27, 94.1% of it development spending, and first payments of TZS 10.4bn and US$2.2m have gone to the Lake Tanganyika crossing into the Democratic Republic of the Congo.

Where the network stops is at the door. 660 public institutions were connected against a target of 900 by December 2025 and 27% of dispensaries have a computer with internet access (2023), even as fibre-to-the-home and office connections grew 157%, from 54,290 to 139,317, between March 2024 and December 2025.

Data Storage

Four public data centres were commissioned as at December 2025, with two more being built at Dodoma and Zanzibar, and the e-Government Authority's Government Data Centre supplies cloud, containerisation and colocation to more than 265 connected ministries, departments, agencies and local authorities (2024).

The commercial estate is thin but building. Wingu Africa's carrier-neutral facility in Dar es Salaam hosts the Tanzania Internet Exchange, holding domestic traffic inside the country; the same operator launched a locally hosted private-cloud platform in April 2026, offered as a compliant alternative to hosting offshore, and Raxio is building a carrier-neutral colocation data centre in Dar es Salaam. What the country does not have is an in-country hyperscale cloud region, so the workloads that matter to a hyperscaler's customers are still served from somewhere else.

Control is being asserted faster than capacity is being added. Moving personal data out of Tanzania requires a permit from the Personal Data Protection Commission, granted only where the destination offers adequate protection or a safeguard is evidenced (2026); the health ministry set storage inside Tanzania as one of three conditions for artificial intelligence in healthcare on 31 July 2026; and the communications ministry says it is establishing a National AI Data Centre so that the country is no longer a source shipping raw data abroad (July 2026). The parliamentary committee scrutinising the communications budget has urged a large upgrade to the National Data Centre, and the national identity register's core data centre and disaster-recovery site were built under the first phase of the ID expansion, with a second phase now in procurement.

Energy

Access to Energy is among Tanzania's ten worst-scoring governance indicators, at 24.7 out of 100 and 38th of 54 in 2023, despite a 13.3-point gain over the decade — a grid that has grown quickly and still reaches 48.3% of the population (2023), with rural access far behind urban.

For business the problem is quality rather than absence: 34% of firms identified electricity as a constraint in the 2023 Enterprise Survey, with outages averaging 0.7 a month. That is the reason power reliability, alongside a shortage of specialised technical skills, is named as what most limits the building and running of data-centre capacity in the country (April 2026). The stress test came in June: a nationwide blackout on 27 June 2026, from about seven in the evening to midnight, was caused by a transmission-line and generation-station chain-reaction fault, and the government appointed an investigation team and directed that load-shedding capability be added, against a statutory quarterly index series the regulator publishes on interruption frequency, duration and unserved energy.

Price is regulated and tiered: the lifeline domestic rate was TZS 100 per kWh for the first 75 kWh a month, rising to TZS 350 above that, with the general domestic tariff at TZS 292 per kWh (December 2025). Even so, a subsistence level of consumption takes several percent of household income for most income groups and under 1% for the wealthiest (2024). Off-grid supply is the part of the system with the most settled rules: Tanzania has a comprehensive off-grid electrification framework with substantial deployment through its Rural Energy Agency (2024), which signed thirty contracts worth 1.2 trillion shillings in January 2026 to electrify 9,009 hamlets across 25 mainland regions and reported all 12,318 mainland villages reached by the end of 2025, with 39,003 of 64,359 hamlets electrified — every village and three in five hamlets are different denominators, and both are the agency's own figures. and rural broadband investment has been built around solar-powered fixed wireless.

Technical Capacity

Tanzania administers better than it builds: Effective Administration is one of its stronger measures at 70.0 out of 100 and 7th of 54 in 2023, up 9.8 points over the decade, inside a Public Administration sub-category scoring 57.2 and ranked 22nd. Government's own digital readiness is more modest, sitting in the middle band of the UN's e-government measure (2024).

The specialist shortage is conceded at the top. The ICT Commission's director general has said the country needs more cyber experts than it has for the size of its user base, and has taken the shortfall to South Korea's Internet & Security Agency for training in digital forensics and misinformation detection (August 2025). The President's Office has instructed public institutions to recruit ICT professionals and to work through the e-Government Authority, which coordinates government systems (September 2025). A shortage of specialised technical skills is named alongside power as what constrains data-centre build (April 2026).

Cyber and data-protection capacity is being assembled through outside partners rather than domestic institutions alone, with several separate partnerships and training tracks recorded since 2025, each running on its own footing.

Below the state, there is an organised developer community holding regular local meetups, and the University of Dar es Salaam's College of Information and Communication Technologies is being built out as the domestic base for artificial intelligence and data-science teaching (March 2026). The systems themselves still rest on foreign suppliers — the core national ID smartcard platform, including its data centre, is held under contract by a Malaysian firm, and the country's largest mobile money platform was migrated to a new core by its parent group in April 2026. The ICT Commission has itself warned that adopting artificial intelligence without matching skills investment risks dependence on foreign technicians to run and maintain it (August 2026).

Cybersecurity

Tanzania scored 99.27 on the ITU's 2024 Global Cybersecurity Index, placing it in Tier 1, the index's highest tier — a score for declared commitments and instruments, of which the country has a full set: the Cybercrimes Act of 2015 is the principal statute, and the ICT Commission runs an annual national Cybersecurity Forum, the fourth held in Arusha in April 2025.

The operational picture is less flattering, and the weak point is the identity layer the state built. SIM-registration agents are supplying online-fraud rings with cards registered under other people's identities (July 2026), a route into the fraud economy that runs through the registration requirement rather than around it; police seizures have traced batches of fraud SIMs back to a single agent registering under a range of names (March 2026). The fraud itself is scripted and recognisable, with operators posing as job advertisers, landlords demanding rent, students in emergencies and faith healers (July 2026). In the health estate, facilities adopting artificial intelligence have been found without basic protections — shared passwords, no encryption, no backups (March 2026).

Governing the estate is a separate matter from defending it. A controller must notify the Personal Data Protection Commission of any security breach without undue delay, and the duty is not conditioned on risk or harm, but neither "security breach" nor "without undue delay" is defined in the Act or its regulations, and no duty runs to the people whose data was taken.

The state is meanwhile buying surveillance faster than defence. A US$145.2 million smart-cities camera programme covers Dar es Salaam, Dodoma and Arusha, of which US$80 million comes from an Abu Dhabi Exports Office concessional loan (May 2025). On the defensive side, the US–Tanzania Cyber Partnership that built regulator capacity closed in 2024, and current capacity work arrives as training delivered with the European Union through Estonia, Germany and Finland (July 2026).

DPI

Data Exchange

Every public institution in Tanzania was ordered onto the government's data-exchange bus by 30 July 2025, with the e-Government Authority building the connections free of charge — a directive that says as much about who was not yet connected as about the bus itself. The Government Enterprise Service Bus, built and run by the e-Government Authority, connects more than 95 public agencies and publishes a live dashboard of connected systems, institutions, endpoints and a connection map filterable by date and sector (2025).

The duty is statutory rather than administrative: the e-Government Act, 2019 obliges public institutions to share data electronically and requires the e-Government Authority to establish and run a data sharing and exchange platform, operationalised as the service bus by the e-Government General Regulations, 2020.

What crosses it is mostly identity verification. NIDA's Common Interface Gateway and APIs reach public and private bodies including the civil registry, the revenue authority, the business registry, the health insurance fund and the social action fund, and company incorporation draws a taxpayer number automatically from the Tanzania Revenue Authority and settles its fees through the government payment gateway. Beyond identity, a Credit Reference Data system has been deployed, with institutions still being onboarded (2025).

A second exchange is being built alongside the first. Jamii X-Change, an ICT ministry and e-Government Authority build under the Digital Tanzania Project, comprises three modules — Jamii Namba for identity, Jamii Kadi for the card and Jamii Malipo for payments (August 2024), and the ministry named Jamii Namba, Jamii X-Change and Jamii Portal as the three systems central to the digital-economy strategy, with the Prime Minister directing every institution head to make their systems interoperable (October 2024). The 2022 e-Government Strategy had set a Huduma Data Exchange Platform to be operational by June 2025 and local government sectoral exchange platforms to be enhanced by June 2024.

Across the border, the East African Community endorsed a regional Secure Data Sharing Framework at a validation workshop in Dar es Salaam in June 2026, while its rules on cross-border data flows still have to pass the Community's decision-making organs.

Digital Identity and CRVS

4,342,926 people who had registered with NIDA still had no national identification number generated as at April 2025, with 461.4m/- allocated in FY2025/26 to clear that backlog, and over 300,000 finished cards were sitting uncollected at district offices in January 2026: being on the register and holding a usable credential are separated by several million people. NIDA had registered more than 25.8 million by April 2025, 81.9% of the 31,582,976 people aged 18 and over recorded in the 2022 census, of whom 21,514,741, or 83.2%, had a number.

Enrolment is not voluntary. The Registration and Identification of Persons Act makes failure to register an offence and the 2014 Regulations require registration within 90 days of turning 18, and the national identification number with biometric verification has been required for SIM registration since 2019. The government has ruled that the NIDA number is itself the Jamii Namba used in delivering and receiving services, rather than a new credential, and the card and its number are the country's authoritative proof of identity, required for a passport, a bank account, government employment and tax registration.

The register still starts at adulthood. Enrolment opens only from age 18, and the Infant Registration Bill that would extend it to newborns had not been tabled and enacted as of early 2026; because no biometric method works for children under five, NIDA links a child's identity to the mother's national ID.

NIDA is procuring a second phase of the register, adding iris and facial recognition to the existing fingerprint biometrics, building a headquarters in Dodoma and extending enrolment offices to 31 districts (April 2026), the first phase having built the core and disaster-recovery data centres and registration offices in 13 districts. A request to print cards in Zanzibar as passports are printed was declined in May 2026, on the grounds that centralised printing protects biometric data and encryption from fraud and leakage.

There is no judicial route of appeal against refusal or cancellation of a national ID: the appeal lies to the Director of Registration and then to the Minister, whose decision is final.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Digital payment stopped being optional in July 2026: the 2026/27 budget makes it compulsory from 1 July across public transport, parking, malls, fuel, gyms, cinemas, hotels and restaurants, all education from pre-primary to university, strategic-crop cooperatives and real-estate, land and vehicle transfers, with Lipa Namba and QR codes offered to small traders, under an Order of the Minister for Finance that binds prospectively and gives businesses already taking cash a transition window.

It lands on an acceptance base built almost entirely without card hardware. Merchants accepting digital payment rose 110% to 2,789,455 in 2025 while the point-of-sale estate stood at 11,803 terminals, so acceptance rests on QR codes and pay numbers. Interoperable merchant transactions reached 86.34 million in 2025, worth TZS 6,413.14 billion, and TANQR, the interoperable QR standard, had 27 participating providers including 21 banks and five mobile network operators.

The switch underneath is the central bank's own. The Bank of Tanzania built the instant payment system in house and operates it directly, as scheme owner and regulator both; 47 financial service providers were connected by December 2025, and in 2023 it carried 235.04 million transactions worth TZS 12,270.47 billion across 45 providers. Active mobile-money accounts rose 6.7% to 75.8 million in 2025, carrying 6.31 billion transactions, and 113 payment service providers held licences as of March 2026.

Price is the live argument. Bank-to-wallet interoperability transfers are capped at TZS 5,000 for amounts above TZS 500,000 and single instant transactions at TZS 2,000, but the Governor has rejected a directed price on payment charges, arguing they are already low and that competition will cut them within six months, pointing instead to substitutions that avoid charges — the instant switch, TanQR, free intra-bank transfers and fee-free ferry and rapid-transit payments.

The national financial inclusion index stood at 0.83 in 2025, its growth driven almost entirely by access rather than usage. A central bank digital currency remains under study and cryptocurrencies are neither legal tender nor regulated, though the sandbox has reviewed 35 fintech applications and approved five for live testing, one a stablecoin cross-border product.

Registries

The register that has moved furthest is the oldest one: birth registration completeness reached 68% by July 2024, from around 10-12% in 2012. Civil registration runs on a single national platform, eRITA, across all 26 mainland regions through more than 12,000 registration points, up from 139 in 2012, with a nationwide 48-hour birth certificate service launched in December 2025, and the simplified under-five pathway that carries most rural registration reached all 26 mainland regions in December 2023. The platform verifies against NIDA, Immigration, the health insurance fund and the public service pension fund, with links to the health management information system, the Judiciary and the statistics bureau under way, and its birth certificate verification for the student loans board has processed over 244,000 checks.

Land is the exception. The digital land register is only partly deployed, e-Ardhi and the Integrated Land Management Information System being scaled under land tenure projects rather than covering the country (2025).

Addressing has gone the other way. 12.9 million residential addresses had been registered by February 2026 under a national addressing and postcode system running since 2010 and certified to the Universal Postal Union's S42 standard, with 29 systems, Tanzania Posts Corporation among them, interconnected with it; Zanzibar's own address programme became operational in June 2025.

On the business side, BRELA runs a nationwide online registration system with a public search of registered entities, verifying directors and shareholders against NIDA and reporting over 90% of its operations conducted digitally, and the 2023/24 Statistical Business Register found 78.1% of 219,371 enumerated establishments formally registered.

The electoral commission maintains a biometric permanent voters register, with 37.6 million voters registered for the October 2025 general election. TASAF's Unified Registry of Beneficiaries is integrated with NIDA and carries an open API for inter-agency access, with links to the health insurance fund and health ministry still outstanding, and the Productive Social Safety Net reached 1.37 million households against a caseload recertified down to about 910,000 in 2024.

Sectoral management information systems

Only 10.6% of dispensaries, which make up the large majority of primary-level facilities, use GoTHoMIS, the main electronic record platform for primary care, against 44.9% of health centres (2023): the line ministries' systems thin out sharply at the point of delivery. Rural primary schools record attendance and examination results on paper, with TAMISEMI's census portal and the education ministry's EMIS platform used to transmit and aggregate annual returns rather than to capture the original record (2025), and the police collect crime and traffic data at every station, rural ones included, on paper or in hand-compiled aggregate, digitised only once it reaches regional or central level (2024).

Where a ministry has built properly, it has built wide. The agriculture ministry's e-Kilimo platform is integrated with NIDA, the revenue authority and its customs system, the business registry, the government payment gateway, the health insurance fund, the fertiliser regulator, the cooperatives system and the meteorological authority, underpinning farmer registration and a digital input-voucher subsidy reaching an estimated 5.4 million beneficiaries (2026). A health information exchange, Tz-HIE, has run on DHIS2 since around 2019, linking approximately 15 discrete health information systems.

The back office is in place on paper. A customs management system, a public-service human resources system with most services digitised and delivered online and an integrated financial management information system covering both central and sub-national government are each recorded in use (2025). The functions they serve have not held up as well: Tax and Revenue Mobilisation fell 12.6 points over 2014-2023 to 41.3 out of 100 and 34th of 54 African states, and Budgetary and Financial Management fell 12.5 points to 68.1.

The Digital Health Strategy 2025-2030 is pushing AI diagnostics into public hospitals, ahead of the record-keeping underneath it.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The World Bank's 2025 GovTech Maturity Index, released in December 2025, puts Tanzania in Group A, "Extensive GovTech Maturity", the top tier, while the UN's E-Government Development Index scored it 0.4327 in 2024, 153rd in the world — two placements that read as opposites. The two measure different ends of the same state: the Group A tier rests on the back-end estate — the data-exchange bus, the HCIMS payroll, the Ajira recruitment portal, the NeST procurement system and the GePG payment gateway — rather than on citizen-facing portals, and digital citizen engagement is the weakest pillar of the index across East Africa, Tanzania included.

What a business can do online is further along than what a citizen can. Tender appeals are filed through the NeST Complaints and Appeals Module, in official use since February 2025, with the Public Procurement Appeals Authority directing all domestic and international bidders to it, and its video-conference hearings have taken cases from bidders based in South Africa, Nigeria, Poland, India and China, extending a Tanzanian administrative remedy to parties who never enter the country. The Immigration Department runs a live national portal for passport, visa and residence permit applications, companies are incorporated and publicly searched through BRELA's online system, births, deaths, marriages and divorces are handled on eRITA, and government fees are paid on a control number through the electronic payment gateway.

Reach beyond the internet is being built deliberately. NIDA runs a free SMS shortcode, 15274, letting a citizen check the status of a national ID without internet access or a visit to an office (December 2025). Against that the credential itself runs the other way: obtaining a national ID is a hybrid rather than an end-to-end digital process — an online form, then a local government office, then a NIDA district office, then a biometric appointment.

The Bank of Tanzania launched a Sovereign Yield Curve system in August 2026, letting investors track secondary-market returns on government securities before investing, against 32,631 retail investors in government securities, up from 897 in 2016.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The public financial system is the one national platform that demonstrably reaches below the centre: Tanzania's integrated financial management information system is in use, built as custom software and covering both central and sub-national government, with programme performance indicators captured across most programmes (2025).

The dates set for extending the exchange layer to that tier have passed. The e-Government Strategy 2022 put June 2024 as the date by which local government authorities' sectoral data exchange platforms would be enhanced, and June 2025 for the Huduma Data Exchange Platform to be operational.

Where the digital state is visible below the national tier, it is in registries rather than in services. Zanzibar's National Address Programme became operational in June 2025, assigning digital addresses to residents and plots — a sub-national administration running its own registry alongside the mainland's. On the mainland, the National Addressing and Postcode System has been registering physical addresses since 2010 under the communications ministry, and had 12.9 million residential addresses registered and interconnection with 29 other systems, Tanzania Posts Corporation among them, by February 2026. What holds it back sits at household level rather than institutional: placards issued to households go uncollected and residents are often unaware of their own house numbers and street names (July 2024).

The lowest rung of government taking part in real-time digital capture is the ward. Ward Executive Offices, alongside health facilities, act as birth registration points at which the record is entered on a mobile application and transmitted to the national register as the paper certificate is handed over (2023) — a national system operated at ward level, rather than a system of the ward's own.

Rural digital data capture

The one thing routinely captured digitally at the point of service outside Tanzania's cities is a birth: at registration points in health facilities and Ward Executive Offices the registrar hands the parent a hand-written certificate on the spot and enters the same record on a mobile application that reaches the Registration Insolvency and Trusteeship Agency's central database in real time (2023).

Little else at that tier works that way. Dispensaries, which make up the large majority of primary-level facilities, were largely paper-based at the point of care, with only a small minority running the primary-care electronic medical record platform and few holding a computer with internet access (2023); the health ministry's own service page now names its eHealth estate — the health management information platform, the human resources system, the health facility registry, the immunisation information system and the supply-chain platform, and the roadmap that would say what any of it reaches at dispensary level does not resolve at its published address. Rural primary schools record attendance and examination results on paper, the government's online education systems carrying annual census returns rather than the original record (2025); against that, a tablet-based literacy and numeracy programme reached 50 rural primary schools and more than 24,000 pupils in Manyara with a second phase under way, and an offline local-server pilot put the national teacher-learning system into eight hard-to-reach schools in Dodoma and Kigoma that have no network — tens of schools, in a system of tens of thousands. Police stations, rural ones included, compile crime and traffic incident data on paper or in hand-written aggregate, digitisation beginning only once the data reaches regional or central level (2024); the recent round of police ICT investment has gone to central stations rather than ordinary ones.

Agriculture is the exception, and a national one. The Ministry of Agriculture's e-Kilimo platform registers farmers and runs a digital input-voucher subsidy, verifying identity against NIDA and connected to the revenue authority, the business registry, the government payment gateway and the health insurance fund (2026). Land runs the other way: the digital land register holds only parcels titled through systematic registration, so most rural land, held under customary or unregistered tenure, has no digital record at all (2025). The physical preconditions improve unevenly — the national broadband backbone now reaches most districts (March 2026) and off-grid power is substantially deployed through the Rural Energy Agency (2024), while 5G remains an urban service.

Rural governance itself scores better than the capture picture suggests. Rural Economy is Tanzania's second best-performing Ibrahim Index sub-category at 75.6 out of 100 and 7th of 54 in 2023, up 8.9 points over the decade. Rural representation and participation reaches 84.2 and 4th of 54 in the same year, while support to the rural economy lags at 65.8, 25th.

Technology

AI

The government says it has a national artificial intelligence strategy and no text of one is public. The ministry's permanent secretary said in March 2026 that the strategy was completed and would provide governance and oversight of the technology, and Tanzania's own July 2026 statement to the United Nations global dialogue describes an implemented national strategy framework of 2026 while acknowledging that liability and oversight rules were still being developed; independent assessments the same month record the guidelines as still being drafted as at 30 July 2026. Whichever is right, the technology was already running in clinical care: the Jakaya Kikwete Cardiac Institute operates AI-enabled echocardiography, a contactless vital-signs monitor and robotic surgery (July 2026), and the Digital Health Strategy 2025-2030 is pushing AI diagnostics into public hospitals more widely.

On paper AI sits inside larger instruments rather than in one of its own. It is one domain among a dozen in the Digital Economy Strategic Framework 2024-2034, which also covers broadband, cybersecurity, data protection and digital identification, and it is a strategic pillar of Vision 2050 (July 2026). The institutional apparatus is younger than the deployments: the ICT Commission convened the country's first National AI Forum in July 2025 under the theme "Inclusive and Ethical AI", its director general arguing that Tanzanian values have to be embedded in AI platforms because platforms without ethical frameworks will not be trusted.

Inside government, the posture is closer to caution than to procurement. The e-Government Authority's 2024 Technology Roadmap lists AI, the Internet of Things and big data as forthcoming rather than deployed on the government service bus; the President's Office told internal auditors to use AI cautiously (September 2025); and the ICT Commission warned in August 2026 against adopting AI "simply because it is a global trend" rather than against the stated national priorities of industrialisation and agricultural productivity.

The sharper domestic argument is about whether Tanzania contributes or only consumes. Officials in July 2026 cast weak data protection in health as a digital-colonialism exposure, and argued that under-publication by Tanzanian experts leaves health AI trained on European and United States material that does not reflect local conditions. A University of Dar es Salaam workshop the same month asked whether East Africans are spectators of these technologies or participants in developing them. The communications ministry has announced work on JAMII AI, a Kiswahili large language model (July 2026). In the public debate about harms, the education minister has put job displacement above fake content as the deeper concern (March 2026).

ICT Industry

Tanzania counted 1,041 active startups in 2024, up 24 percent, employing 138,453 people, with foreign direct investment into them doubling to $53m of which fintech took $41.4m. The physical base under that is a hub network that passed 25 hubs in 2024, with a newly launched Tanzania Hubs Network counting more than 35 member hubs supporting over 200 startups (November 2024).

What has not followed is weight in the national economy. The ICT sector's share of GDP has stayed at roughly one and a half percent (June 2026) even as connectivity has widened — well short of the share the Digital Economy Strategic Framework targets for 2029. The larger operators serving the market are moving faster than that number:

Wingu Africa launched a locally hosted private cloud platform in Tanzania in April 2026 as a compliant alternative to hosting offshore, and Vodacom Tanzania replaced the core M-Pesa platform in the same month. Firms of every kind still contend with power: 34 percent named electricity as a constraint in the 2023 Enterprise Survey.

Innovation ecosystem

Tanzania is preparing one of 17 ITU Acceleration Centres worldwide, managed by the ICT Commission with the regulator TCRA involved, under a hosting agreement signed in February 2024 and given final approval in Geneva (April 2026). It is anchored on the Jamii Namba national identity system as its digital public infrastructure foundation. On the broader measure, Tanzania ranked 120th on WIPO's Global Innovation Index in 2024.

The state has an innovation function of its own. The World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment records a public-sector innovation strategy with a programme behind it, covering digital skills and public service innovation, and records government engagement with technology startups alongside public-private arrangements for online service delivery (2025). The Bank of Tanzania runs a regulatory sandbox admitting fintech products for live testing, and the Digital Economy Strategic Framework sets targets for regional innovation hubs and startup numbers by 2029. Private financing is the thinner part: Tanzanian rounds are tracked in continent-wide venture reporting at a scale below Africa's leading markets (2025).

None of that settles whether the country produces technology or absorbs it. A July 2026 University of Dar es Salaam workshop concluded that AI governance alone will deliver nothing unless Tanzania builds local innovation capacity, protects its own data and empowers startups to produce home-grown solutions. Zanzibar is building a route of its own: the first international campus of IIT Madras has graduated data-science and AI cohorts there (July 2026).

Capacity

Literacy

Public perception of education provision is Tanzania's single most improved governance measure of the decade to 2023, up 37.2 points to 92.5 out of 100 and first of 54 African countries — and it sits a long way above what the schools are measured as delivering. Education Enrolment scored 31.1 out of 100 and ranked 40th of 54 in 2023, having gained 1.7 points across the whole decade, while Education Completion fell 6.8 points to 39.4, 25th of 54. The teaching side is the country's strength: Education Quality rose 12.4 points to 47.6, 21st of 54, and Human Resources in Education, at 87.1, is among Tanzania's ten best-scoring indicators, though that one has slipped 3.0 points over the same decade. A country that ranks first in Africa for what its citizens think of its schools and fortieth for how many children are in them is not short of goodwill towards the education system; it is short of children finishing it.

Basic digital literacy reached a minority of the population (2021), which is the constraint every consumer-facing digital service in the country is built against. That has begun to shape financial policy rather than education policy. The chair of the National Council for Financial Inclusion named financial literacy, product quality and household resilience as the unfinished business behind the inclusion figures, with the usage gap rather than access now the limiting factor (July 2026), and as governor of the Bank of Tanzania has said payments infrastructure alone will not carry the cash-lite transition without sustained financial education. The comprehension problem is now being written into rules as well as speeches: the 2025 financial consumer protection amendments require providers to publish their rates in Kiswahili as well as English.

Training and skills

The Personal Data Protection Commission and the Open University of Tanzania launched a national Certified Data Protection Officer programme in July 2026, the university training and assessing candidates and the Commission certifying them, aimed at government, finance, telecoms, healthcare, education and technology. The demand for it is statutory: section 27(3) of the Personal Data Protection Act makes appointing a data protection officer mandatory for data controllers. Alongside it the ICT Commission trained 110 participants in Dar es Salaam in July 2026 across four named priority areas — artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, personal data protection and emerging technologies, delivered with the European Union through Estonian, German and Finnish public-sector expertise, and drawing non-governmental organisations in alongside public and private institutions. A year earlier the Commission had run a three-day workshop in Arusha for risk coordinators, board members, IT officers and auditors, its director general naming insecure IT systems and the absence of data-management policy as the core privacy risk (June 2025).

Three separate data-protection capacity channels are running at the same time, each with its own institutional home and its own foreign partner.

At degree level the pipeline is narrow and concentrated: ICT degree programmes are led by the University of Dar es Salaam and the University of Dodoma, and the state is buying the top of the skill range abroad — the education minister said in March 2026 that Tanzania had sent 16 graduates to South Africa and 34 to Ireland to study artificial intelligence and data science. In Zanzibar, IIT Madras's first international campus has graduated data-science and AI cohorts. For officials, Tanzania records both a digital skills strategy and a digital skills programme, with its material freely available (2025), and the Digital Tanzania Project funds skills work among its other components.

None of that reaches the schools. In Mbeya, formal training on the education information system does not reach most teachers, leaving the digital reporting step to a single, often self-taught, member of staff per school (2025).

Research institutions

Tanzanian officials turned the country's thin research output into a sovereignty argument in July 2026, holding that under-publication by Tanzanian experts leaves health artificial intelligence trained on European and United States material that does not reflect local realities, and casting that alongside weak health-sector data protection as an exposure to digital colonialism. It is an unusual line for a government to take about its own knowledge base, and it identifies the gap precisely: the systems are adopted here, the evidence behind them is produced elsewhere.

The institutional answer is being built at one address. The University of Dar es Salaam's College of Information and Communication Technologies is being built out under the HEET project as the domestic base for AI and data-science teaching and research (March 2026), and a parliamentary committee visit there in March 2026 framed universities as the institutions that must train for AI's governance, ethics and security dimensions, with the education minister naming job displacement as a deeper concern than fake content. The same college is one of the two universities that carry ICT degree provision, so teaching capacity and research capacity rest on the same small institutional base.

Output does exist and it is aimed at domestic problems: researchers there designed and evaluated an FAQ chatbot for the Tanzania Ports Authority, published in a peer-reviewed regional journal in August 2026. Against that, Tanzania's standing on the Global Innovation Index (2024) places it well down the international field.

Inclusion

Access to services

Tanzania's own financial-inclusion index reached 0.83 in 2025, but almost the whole gain was on access rather than use, the access sub-index moving from 0.84 to 0.87 while usage went from 0.78 to 0.79. Its chair named product quality, financial literacy and household resilience as the unfinished business, the usage gap rather than access now the limiting factor (July 2026).

What arrived is agent build-out, not bank build-out. Financial access points rose 33.5% to 2.27 million in 2025, of which nearly 2 million are mobile-money agents, and banks have been pushed towards the places money changes hands, with auction-day branches at mining and livestock markets (July 2026). Credit shows the pattern in reverse: MSME loan accounts more than doubled to 578,692 in 2025 while the value of MSME lending fell 23.2% to TZS 10.4 trillion: more borrowers, less money.

Obtaining what the state provides remains largely physical. Getting a national ID means an online form, then a local government office for the chairman's stamp, then a NIDA district office, then a biometric appointment, and the national service portal is recorded at the informational level, where a citizen can find out about a service but cannot complete it (2025). Services are increasingly keyed to the register — student loans were tied to the national ID in May 2025 — which puts registration's reach, not the technology, in the way.

The last mile fails the same way at both ends: address placards issued to households go uncollected, and residents are often unaware of their own house numbers and street names (July 2024), while processed national ID cards sit uncollected at district offices (January 2026).

Some cannot use what exists at all: refugees and asylum seekers may open a lowest-tier mobile-money account without formal identity documents, but cashing in and out demands papers most of them cannot obtain, and no law requires digital payment systems to accommodate persons with disabilities, leaving accessibility voluntary and uneven (2025).

Retail delivery is running at about half of plan: fibre-to-the-door reached 64,266 of 126,740 planned customers and public Wi-Fi 61 of 120 planned sites (March 2026).

Digital divides

Tanzania's smartphone base shrank over the quarter to March 2026, falling from 29.8 million users to 28.5 million with the cost of handsets named as the reason, even as penetration sat at 42.5% and network build-out went on. The contraction arrives at the worst possible moment: penetration had reached 41.8% in 2025, up from 36% a year earlier, still leaving most of the population without a smartphone as digital payment becomes mandatory.

The sharpest line is gender. Tanzanian women were 41% less likely than men to use mobile internet in 2023, one of the wider gaps GSMA measures. Credit moved the same way in 2025: women's loan accounts rose 4.2% while the value of their borrowing fell, and lending to young people fell 20% in value to TZS 4.05 trillion.

Cost is the second line, and the cash-lite mandate has turned it into a live argument. Government Notice No. 158C does not say who bears the transaction charge on a payment it requires to be electronic, so the fee falls wherever commercial practice leaves it. One month in, users were pressing the Bank of Tanzania to set a directed price on transfer and payment charges, arguing that absent a cap each provider sets its own rate and the customer carries it (July 2026).

Geography and the registers carry the rest. 5G's geographical footprint remains small and urban even as its population coverage climbs, the large majority of land, held under customary and unregistered tenure, sits outside the digital land register, and rural health managers draw on digital records in their decisions markedly less than urban ones. Underneath all of it, basic digital literacy reaches only a minority of Tanzanians (2021).

Data

National statistics

Tanzania's statistical system is markedly better at using data than at producing it: on the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators it scores above 89% on data use, and between 70% and 89% on data services and data products, but only 50-69% on both data sources and data infrastructure (2023) — the two pillars that measure collection and systems capacity.

The set-piece exercises are not the weak point. Population, agricultural and business censuses have all been run within the last ten years, meeting the test on all three (2023), and the survey programme is dense where it counts households and farms: three or more household surveys and three or more agricultural surveys in the decade, against two health surveys, two labour surveys and a single business survey. Firms are the blind spot, not people. The statistical office's own capacity has been improving slowly from a middling base, its Capacity of the Statistical System score reaching 54.6 out of 100 in 2023, 21st of 54 African states, after a rise of 4.4 points over 2014-2023.

The National Bureau of Statistics has been working the administrative side of that gap, issuing a 2024 manual for strengthening and integrating administrative data into national statistics and its statistical business register now runs on them: integrating mainland and Zanzibar tax records with other administrative sources lifted the count of establishments from 219,371 to 257,405, a gain of 17.3 per cent in a year, which is a sampling-frame improvement as much as a finding. The strategy behind that work is the second statistical master plan, running 2022/23 to 2026/27 at a budgeted 384 million dollars, which the finance ministry's steering committee reported 88.9 per cent implemented in July 2026, a year before it closes; the offices published a first national assessment of the skills, infrastructure, policy and data-sharing constraints on big-data use in October 2025 and the country's first nationally integrated labour force survey, covering the mainland and Zanzibar together across 14,232 households, in 2026. What limits that substitution is the state of the records at the point of collection: crime and traffic incidents are compiled at every police station, rural ones included, on paper or in hand-written aggregate and digitised only once they reach regional or central level (2024), and rural primary schools record attendance and examination results on paper, with the government's education portals used to transmit and aggregate annual returns rather than to capture the original record (2025). Administrative data can only be as timely as the paper underneath it.

Open data

Getting information out of the Tanzanian state has become harder over the past decade, not easier: Accessibility of Public Records scored 25.9 out of 100 in 2023, 33rd of 54 African states and down 5.3 points over the decade, with Disclosure of Public Records at 33.1 and 28th, inside an Accountability and Transparency sub-category that fell 4.9 points to 48.5.

No general national open data policy has ever been adopted — one drafted in 2016 and 2017 was submitted and its lack of official adoption recorded — so what governs release is sectoral: the statistics bureau's 2024 dissemination policy sets an open-access tier and principles of transparency, accessibility, timeliness and confidentiality, the procurement authority's 2025 policy mandates publication of procurement data in open contracting format, and the two statistics offices run an integrated portal bringing administrative, demographic and survey data together. Tanzania does run a government open data portal carrying a data catalogue (2025), and what is published through the statistical system skews hard towards the economy. On the Open Data Inventory, balance of payments and government finance each score 7.5 out of 10, banking 7.0, and national accounts and prices 6.5, against pollution at 3.0, education facilities at 3.5, and crime and agriculture at 4.0 (2024). Money is counted and shown; the environment and the justice system are not.

Across the 22 scored Open Data Inventory categories Tanzania averaged 5.2 out of 10 in 2024, economic categories averaging 6.4 against 4.8 for social and 4.4 for environmental data.

Government's documentation of its own digital estate is tighter still. Across a majority of the GovTech domains assessed in 2025 — the digital transformation strategy, the government cloud, the interoperability framework, the access-to-information and data protection regimes, and the financial, HR, payroll, customs, tax, procurement and treasury systems among them — the supporting document is recorded as existing but held internally rather than published.

The systems themselves divide on this. The e-Government Authority's exchange layer publishes a live dashboard of connected systems, institutions and endpoints, with an interoperability map filterable by date and sector, and BRELA's registration system carries a public search of registered companies and business names (2025). Against that, the rules governing the instant payment scheme are released to participants and non-participants only on request rather than published, unlike the National Payment Systems Act and the TACH and TISS rules (2024), and the terms on which the identity authority shares data with other institutions are not published at all.

Use of satellite data

The geospatial capability being built is in land administration: Korea's Economic Development Cooperation Fund is financing a US$65 million concessional loan, signed in October 2022, to digitise Tanzania's land information system — parcel data, certificates of occupancy and customary land rights — and to produce digital cadastral maps for the lands ministry in Dar es Salaam and its zonal offices. No national space or geospatial data policy had been adopted as at August 2026.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Both American programmes that built Tanzanian public-sector digital capacity have ended. A US$2 million U.S.–Tanzania Cyber Partnership ran from 2022 to 2024, implemented by DAI, working on 5G and 6G policy frameworks and on cybersecurity capacity at the Tanzania Communications Regulatory Authority. Before it, a US$12 million USAID health information systems activity ran from 2017 to 2022 on DHIS2, facility management information systems and the use of health data in decision-making.

Above those programmes sits a package of instruments the record had not held: a March 2023 White House statement carries an export-financing memorandum of up to 500 million dollars covering digital technology and a 5G-security and cyber-cooperation memorandum signed on 27 March. Health data is where the American money has otherwise gone. USAID and PEPFAR have funded Digital Square's work with the Ministry of Health since 2021 on DHIS2, FHIR-compliant health data exchange, digital vaccine management and interoperability between health systems, and a PEPFAR cooperative agreement awarded in 2021, implemented by PATH through the US Centers for Disease Control, works on the government's capacity to run interoperable health information systems for HIV and TB epidemic control, covering governance, quality improvement and workforce support.

The US platform presence is commercial and thin. Airtel Africa's distribution agreement with SpaceX covers Tanzania as one of fourteen markets, layering Starlink capacity over the terrestrial network (May 2025). No United States hyperscaler operates a cloud region or a data centre in the country as at August 2026, though a Tanzanian organisation was selected in June 2026 for a hyperscaler social entrepreneur accelerator with cloud and artificial-intelligence support, and a data-centre developer whose major shareholder is American-founded passed 380 million dollars of committed capital in July 2026 with a Tanzanian carrier-neutral facility in its pipeline — capital for multi-country growth rather than a bounded Tanzanian allocation.

China activities

Above the vendors there is a state-level instrument: a joint statement of 3 November 2022 establishes the comprehensive strategic cooperative partnership, covering investment, infrastructure, trade, energy, minerals and digital and green development alongside implementation of the belt and road memorandum, with the digital content one clause of a general text and no digital-specific Chinese instrument with Tanzania held. Below it the presence is vendor-led, and it comes with its own money rather than a donor's. Huawei is both supplier and lender on the national broadband backbone: a buyer's credit to Tanzania Telecommunications Corporation is financing the extension of the National ICT Broadband Backbone into further districts (2023).

The rest is equipment and donated systems. Huawei, with its distributor Redington, launched Wi-Fi 7 for government offices in Tanzania along with an SME kit, and set out an interest in hosting for public institutions and banks (June 2025). Further back, ZTE's donated Safe Zanzibar project installed full-HD cameras on the main roads of Stone Town and a command centre with a video wall in Malindi, using GIS, a case library and analysis tools to give administrative departments a shared surveillance system (June 2015).

EU activities

German development finance is rebuilding the machinery of Tanzanian health cover. KfW is funding an €8 million programme over 2022–2026 to rebuild the IT systems of the National Health Insurance Fund, whose systems and processes were built to administer about 3.6 million members (2022), ahead of a planned mandatory scheme covering the country's roughly 56 million people. A second KfW programme of €8.5 million over 2023–2026 is building digital traffic-management systems for the protected areas that cover 38% of national territory, Serengeti among them, and BMZ is funding a €3 million Digital Transformation Centre over 2024–2027 building expertise in applying digital approaches to gender equality and human rights.

The Union's own commitments are broader and run longer, and there is now a figure over all of them: the first partnership dialogue under the Samoa Agreement, in December 2024, recorded European commitments of 726 million euros for 2021 to 2027, a planned security dialogue and Tanzania's first request under the European Peace Facility, naming no standalone digital instrument. Digital4Tanzania commits €11.55 million over 2021–2030 to connectivity, governance and reducing inequality and unemployment across the mainland and Zanzibar; €11.1 million over 2021–2026 goes to the Business Environment, Growth and Innovation programme, which pairs ICT infrastructure capacity with the Blueprint for Regulatory Reforms; and €1.485 million over 2022–2026 funds the Tanzania Inclusive Digital Economy programme on digital infrastructure, tools, policy and affordable digitally-enabled services. The European Investment Bank approved financing for Axian Telecom's mobile broadband expansion in 2025, part of it for Tanzania and backed by a European Commission budgetary guarantee under Global Gateway.

Delivery runs partly through member-state institutions. The ICT Commission's training in Dar es Salaam in late July 2026 covered artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, personal data protection and emerging technologies, and was delivered with the Union through Estonian, German and Finnish public-sector expertise. EU-funded UNICEF work to expand birth registration and legal identity for under-18s across ten districts in Tanga, Mwanza and Dar es Salaam was announced in June 2026 to begin that August.

Gulf/UAE activities

The Gulf's stake in Tanzania's digital build is a single credit line, and what it buys is surveillance. An Abu Dhabi Exports Office concessional loan of US$80 million funds the larger part of a US$145.2 million smart-cities camera programme for Dar es Salaam, Dodoma and Arusha, announced in the Home Affairs budget (May 2025). The instrument record is wider than the credit line: a visit by the Emirati foreign minister on 5 May 2025 produced a signed customs cooperation agreement, a memorandum on mining-sector investment and a memorandum establishing a bilateral business council, none of the three digital-specific. No Gulf state or Gulf-owned operator holds a connectivity, cloud or platform position in the country as at August 2026.

India activities

Education is the whole of the Indian footprint that has produced anything. IIT Madras Zanzibar, the Indian Institute of Technology Madras's first international campus, has graduated data-science and artificial-intelligence cohorts as Zanzibar works to build a startup base from the islands (July 2026).

Alongside it, the Tanzania Privacy Professionals Association announced a memorandum of understanding with India's Sandbox Security and with TAFINA in August 2026, framed as combining legal safeguards with technical and security measures to protect end users; the parties are a professional association and private firms rather than the state. India holds no financing commitment and no infrastructure or systems contract in Tanzania as at August 2026.

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